



## MONTHLY UPDATE

# Mali: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-06 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

*Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

## Summary of the month

A five-day digital week set the agenda and nothing was enacted. The [fourth Semaine du Numerique](#) produced a [recommendation set](#) covering a national artificial-intelligence strategy, a data-management law, a startups law, a national digital council, a regional protocol on artificial-intelligence governance and a law making the state operator the sole holder of national transport infrastructure – six instruments, all at the recommendation stage.

Against that agenda, the working parts are the data-protection authority and the courts. The authority [opened its second session of the year with more than 1,000 files](#) and [authorised the processing of demobilisation beneficiary data, with three days of training on it](#). In the other direction, a press-freedom body [reported cybercrime provisions being used to prosecute journalists](#), while the government [launched a disinformation awareness campaign targeting 60,000 people](#) and a civil-society body [launched a content-checking application](#).

## Governance

### Strategies, plans and policies

On 15 July, at the UEMOA digital economy salon in Ouagadougou, Mali [spoke for the three AES states and the salon adopted a Declaration de Ouagadougou](#) recommending that member governments place digital at the centre of national strategies, and identifying financing opportunities under the union's ICT fund. The [same](#) [communiqué records the minister at the Global Dialogue on AI Governance and the World Summit on the Information Society in Geneva from 6 to 10 July](#), arguing for Global South data rights, fairer sharing of the benefits of artificial intelligence, a capacity-building fund for least-developed countries, and the integration of African languages into AI models. Positions stated, with no instrument or commitment attached to any of them.

The same 1 August recommendations also included establishing a [Conseil national du Numerique](#).

### Legislation and regulation

On 29 July the Garde des Sceaux [instructed all prosecutors, justices of the peace and judicial police to act against networks recruiting through WhatsApp, TikTok and Snapchat](#). The communiqué enumerates existing penal qualifications and adds that the staging, filming, publication and commentary of such images are themselves offences falling under cybercrime; no new statute was made, no platform was notified, and parents, educators, landlords and hotel keepers are called on to watch and denounce.

On 1 August the Semaine du Numerique's recommendations included [a data-management law and a startups law](#).

## Data protection

On 3 August the [data-protection authority opened its second 2026 session](#) with more than 1,000 files before it over ten days — authorisations, declarations, video-surveillance oversight, formal notices and direct sanction procedures — its president grounding the sanctions in Loi n2013-015 as amended.

## Regional collaboration

On 24 July Mali was [re-elected to the African Telecommunications Union board for 2027-2031](#) at the Abuja plenipotentiary.

The same 1 August recommendations also included [a protocol between AES states to harmonise AI governance](#).

## Standards

The standards agency's own budget is the month's clearest measure of it. Its fourteenth ordinary board session [balanced a 2026 budget of CFA 243,306,303 against CFA 318,369,036 in 2025, a fall of about a quarter](#), and it [holds a correspondent member profile with the international standards organisation](#). The agency was created by ordinance in March 2012; no standard adopted, certification issued or staffing figure is published, so what is measurable about it is the money.

## Public debate and participation in policymaking

The same 3 August the cybercrime pole [sentenced Chahana Takiou to 12 months with six suspended](#) on a charge of undermining the credit of the state through the judicial institution, over remarks at a Bamako media forum in June 2026 arguing that journalists should be tried under press-offence law.

## ICT Infrastructure

### Connectivity

On 15 July CSquared [added capacity on the 2Africa West subsea system](#) to the West African backbone whose inland fibre reaches Mali, giving an independent route behind the Abidjan, Accra and Lagos landings.

On 23 July Moov Africa Malitel [announced the retirement of ADSL and migration to FTTH by end-2026](#); no subscriber or coverage figure accompanied it.

On 27 July Maliweb carried a named-analyst investigation into the universal access fund which also [reports AFRIBONE as the sole surviving independent internet provider](#), buying wholesale IP transit at near-retail prices after incumbents allegedly pressed the backbone operator to stop selling dark fibre.

On 30 July the Semaine du Numerique's opening panel [set a universal connectivity target of 2030](#), with the roadmap to be drafted jointly with Burkina Faso and Niger. On 1 August the week's recommendations included [a law making SMTD-SA the sole national operator of transport, transmission, storage and broadcast infrastructure](#).

## DPI

### Data Exchange

The national public key infrastructure and electronic signature services were [recommended for effective deployment at the digital week on 1 August](#). Nothing names a first service, an operator or a date.

Customs is the one exchange with a build behind it. At a Bamako round table on 7 August convened by the Prime Minister's office and the chamber of commerce with private operators, the customs directorate [presented a project to interconnect customs information systems for goods in transit](#), aimed at cutting customs, transit and import-export processing times and building on a World Bank technical mission of 31 July. [Mali's implementation of the WTO Trade Facilitation Agreement was put at 83.6%](#) at the same consultation. No counterpart administration, timetable, cost or system name is stated.

## Registries

A [national digital directory of diaspora skills](#) was launched at a ceremony in Washington on 22 August 2026, run by the Malian embassy to the United States and registering professional profiles across economic, administrative, academic, private-sector and emerging fields so that ministries can identify expertise against specific needs. The minister described it as an accreting database whose usefulness depends on take-up and on profiles being kept current; questions at the ceremony went to registration terms and to how the recorded data would be used, and no data-protection basis is stated.

## Sectoral management information systems

Three health systems reached the record in the same window and none of them carries a coverage figure. The national health information system [publishes its own description — case detection, the launch of interventions to prevent transmission and reduce morbidity, and the surveillance behind them](#), running under a health and social information strategic plan for 2020-2024 whose period has expired and a national digital health plan for 2024-2028. The health insurance fund and the bodies it delegates management to [signed contracts towards universal coverage in July 2026](#), after digitising prior authorisation in May. And the revenue directorate [opened three options for filing declarations and depositing financial statements](#) in April 2026. No enrolment, claims volume or filing share is published for any of the three.

## Digitalisation

### Digitalisation of sub-national government

One commune is taking its own revenue problem in hand. Koutiala [began digitising its fiscal census and financial management, surveying taxable commercial equipment and public-space use and equipping the town hall with financial-management tools](#), to widen its own-source revenue. It is funded by a foreign embassy and run with a non-governmental organisation, and no budget, timetable or revenue target is stated.

### Rural digital data capture

The same week [recommended an updated universal-access strategy with a white-zone map, against a 2030 universal connectivity target](#). No map, coverage baseline or funding line accompanies the recommendation.

## Technology

### AI

On 1 August the Semaine du Numerique [recommended a national AI strategy](#), which Mali does not have, alongside an AES protocol on AI governance. The [Centre d'intelligence artificielle et de robotique](#) closed the week with a [demonstration of a locally built intrusion-detection technology](#).

Mali joined a regional framework rather than making one. Six francophone West African states [adopted common artificial-intelligence governance guidelines on 9 July](#), led by an advocacy organisation and announced at the [Global Dialogue on AI Governance](#). The guidelines are non-binding and no Malian implementing instrument follows from them on the record.

## Innovation ecosystem

A civil-society organisation [launched an application for reporting and checking online content, alongside the closing report of a digital campaign against viral falsehood which it says reached 68,885 people](#). It is aimed at young people and civil-society organisations, and funded through a Danish foreign-ministry facility with support from the ministry responsible for communication and the digital economy. No user or report-volume figure is published.

## Capacity

### Training and skills

The same 22 July an operator [reported 350 young people placed on the labour market](#) from its digital centre.

On 30 July UNESCO and Japan [handed the education ministry FCFA 88,740,927 of equipment for eight teacher-training institutes](#) — 40 laptops, 16 all-in-one computers, 32 tablets, and projectors, whiteboards, printers and backup devices — with no maintenance, connectivity or software provision stated.

On 1 August recruitment opened for the first cohort of a [digital-skills programme for 15,000 young people](#) run under a convention with the Association Kabakoo.

## Inclusion

### Access to services

The month's one measure of what connectivity costs a Malian is a comparison with the neighbour. About [1.5GB of mobile data in Bamako buys what 25GB buys in Dakar](#) — a ratio of roughly 25 to 1, which critics attribute to weak market oversight by the regulator, the duopoly of the two incumbent operators, and the years since a new operator licence was issued. It is a press comparison rather than a regulator or operator tariff series, and neither the basket nor the date of the prices compared is stated; taken at its own weight it still sits awkwardly against the digital-sovereignty case the same month's fora were built around.

## Data

### National statistics

The statistics institute runs a [microdata archive under its own domain holding 107 studies](#), led by the 2022 census and near-annual agricultural surveys since 1996/1997. It is a first-party statistical archive rather than a whole-of-government open-data portal, and the base holds nothing of the latter kind.

### Open data

Open data moved from absent to partial. The statistics institute [publishes an open data licence agreement](#) and held a national workshop in June 2026 on statistical data modelling and [migration to a second-generation open data portal platform](#). Both are the institute's, covering its own data rather than government data generally, and the base still holds no dataset count, portal address or open-data policy instrument.

## Use of satellite data

Work is under way to [finalise the creation by decree of an integrated national measurement, reporting and verification system](#) for the nationally determined contribution. No decree number, data source list or operator is on file.

## Geopolitics

### EU activities

There is [no dedicated European Union country programme for Mali for 2025 to 2027](#): the country is funded instead from the central-Sahel complex-settings allocation, with no digital or data-governance activity named in either tranche. No separate termination instrument for the previous programme has been found.

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